

Scenario Question: Cybersecurity Breach and Employee Responsibility

Scenario:

TechNova Sdn. Bhd. is a software company that develops banking applications for financial institutions. The company stores sensitive customer information, including personal details, financial records, and system designs. Employees are required to follow strict cybersecurity policies, including protecting confidential information and reporting any security concerns.

Recently, Amir, an employee from the IT department, discovered that his colleague had downloaded thousands of customer records onto a personal USB drive without approval. The colleague claimed that the data was only for "backup purposes" and had no intention of misusing it. However, Amir also noticed that the company had not conducted cybersecurity awareness training for employees for more than two years, and several employees were sharing passwords to access systems faster.

Amir reported the issue to his manager, but the manager dismissed the concern and advised him not to "create unnecessary problems" because the company was preparing for an important business partnership. Worried that customer information might be exposed, Amir is considering reporting the issue through external whistleblowing channels.

Questions:

a) Identify **TWO ethical issues** presented in this scenario and explain why they are concerns.

(4 marks)

b) Discuss whether Amir should proceed with whistleblowing. Support your answer by explaining the responsibilities of employees and the importance of protecting organisational information.

(6 marks)

c) Explain how TechNova should demonstrate **corporate accountability** in managing this cybersecurity risk. Provide TWO actions the organisation should take.

(4 marks)

d) Explain how the organisation's ICT policies and monitoring practices can help prevent similar incidents in the future.

(6 marks)